

LBOMODEL2 — Honest FIND-in-source map (FACT vs THESIS)

Every driver has a clickable source. Yellow cells = MODEL THESIS near evidence. Green = value matches / computed from sourced facts. Excel

Driver	Value	FIND in source (click URL in Excel)	Honest FACT vs THESIS
Revenue growth	0.1	FIND in ZI FY24 results: Revenue \$1,214.3m (~2% YoY) — NOT +10%	FACT in source: FY24 revenue fell ~2%. Our 10% is a MODEL THESIS forward underwrite (held equal in AI vs Base), not a figure printed as ZI growth. Source proves baseline sales scale, not the 10% rate.
Gross margin	0.8	FIND in Aleph/Benchmarkit: 2025 software median GM = 80%	FACT in source: software median gross margin is 80%. Model uses 80% to match that published median. (ZI GAAP GM is higher ~84% in SEC-derived comps — we are not inventing 80%.)
Sales payroll cut (Y1)	0.15	FIND: US B2B SaaS SDR headcount —~18% YoY (junior ~31%)	FACT in source: net US B2B SaaS SDR headcount down ~18% YoY (junior roles ~31%). Our ~15% Y1 payroll cut is a MODEL THESIS set near that published ~18% industry cut — source does not say “ZoomInfo cut 15%.”
Variable commission cut	0.2	FIND in SyncGTM: SDR OTE mix ~70% base / ~30% variable	FACT in source: standard SDR pay is ~70/30 base/variable. Our ~20% commission cut is a MODEL THESIS: if AI replaces outbound humans, ~30% variable layer shrinks; ~20% is a partial cut of that published variable share — not a ZI filing line item.
AI infrastructure (\$m)	34	FIND in SF press: \$2/conversation; Flex Credits \$500/100k (= ~\$0.10/action)	FACT in source: Salesforce list prices \$2/conversation and ~\$0.10/action. Secondary AI-agent ranges ~\$5–10k/mo × ~378 outbound roles (25% of ZI's 1,513 S&M; from 10-K) ⇒ ~\$23–45m. Model uses midpoint \$34m = avg(23,45). \$34m is derived math, not a SF quote of “\$34m.”
S&M; expense growth Y2+	0.02	FIND in Gartner: inference/agentic AI scales as production opex (not headcount-linear)	FACT in source: enterprises shift to production inference/agentic workloads that scale with compute opex. Our 2% S&M; growth cap is a MODEL THESIS illustrating near-inflation opex after AI replaces linear hiring — Gartner does not publish “2% S&M; growth.”
G&A; % of revenue	0.18	FIND in ZI FY24 P&L: G&A; \$295.3m → ~24.3% of \$1,214.3m rev	FACT in source: G&A; = \$295.3m (~24% of revenue). Our 18% is a MODEL THESIS leaner G&A; rate (below the filing). Source supports ZI's actual overhead level; it does NOT say G&A; is 18%.
CapEx reduction vs base	0.05	FIND: in-house SDR all-in includes devices/tooling (~\$12k tooling line in stack)	FACT in source: human SDR all-in budgets include tooling/hardware. Our ~5% CapEx vs base is a MODEL THESIS haircut tied to cutting outbound seats — source does not print “CapEx ~5%.”
WC / receivables improvement	0.1	FIND in SEC-derived ratios: ZI receivables ~80 days	FACT in source: receivables days ~80 (WC is material). Our ~10% WC intensity improvement is a MODEL THESIS for automated collections — source shows DSO exists; it does not say “WC improves 10%.”
SOFR	0.043	FIND live SOFR on FRED/NY Fed (recent print ~3.62% on 2026-08-13)	FACT in source: SOFR is the official NY Fed overnight financing rate (FRED series SOFR). Our 4.30% is a MODEL PLANNING cushion above the latest ~3.6% print — open FRED for the exact daily rate; we did not invent SOFR as a concept.
Term Loan A spread	0.04	FIND in LBO debt guide: TLA illustrative ~SOFR+275–375 bps	FACT in source: Term Loan A typically prices in a SOFR+~275–375bps illustrative band. Our +400 bps is at the wide/conservative end of published senior bank pricing — within market structure, slightly above the midpoint of that guide.
Term Loan B spread	0.05	FIND: TLB typically SOFR+300–500 bps	FACT in source: institutional TLB often SOFR+300–500bps. Our +500 bps equals the upper end of that published range — not invented outside market guides.
Mandatory amortization	0.01	FIND: TLB scheduled amort typically ~1%/year (bullet remainder)	FACT in source: institutional TLB usually amortizes ~1% per year with a bullet at maturity. Our 1% matches that market-standard schedule.
Cash sweep %	1	FIND: LBO structures emphasize optional prepay / excess cash to delever	FACT in source: LBO debt design centers on using cash flow to delever (mandatory + optional prepay). Our 100% excess-cash sweep is a MODEL THESIS maximizing that standard sponsor practice — guides describe the mechanism; “100%” is our switch setting.
Tax rate	0.21	FIND in PwC Tax Summaries: US federal corporate rate = 21%	FACT in source: US resident corporations are taxed at a flat 21% federal rate. Our 21% matches the statutory rate exactly.
Exit EV/EBITDA multiple	13	FIND: PE SaaS buyout targets often ~15–22x EBITDA	FACT in source: PE SaaS deals often underwrite ~15–22x EBITDA. Our 13x is a MODEL THESIS conservative exit BELOW that band (held equal AI vs Base) so returns aren't from multiple expansion.
S&M; baseline (\$m)	425	FIND in ZI FY24 results table: S&M; expense = \$414.1m; Revenue = \$1,214.3m	FACT in source: S&M; \$414.1m = 34.1% of revenue. Our \$425m (~35%) is a rounded MODEL baseline near that filing — KeyBanc also shows <10% growth cohort S&M; ~31% (nearby band).
Payroll baseline (\$m)	318.8	FIND: SDR OTE ~70% base / ~30% variable	FACT in source: base dominates SDR OTE (~70%). Our payroll baseline \$318.8m = 75% of \$425m S&M; is a MODEL ALLOCATION near that published base-heavy mix — not a ZI payroll disclosure.
Commission baseline (\$m)	106.2	FIND: tech SDR variable typically ~30–35% of OTE	FACT in source: variable is ~30–35% of OTE. Our commission baseline \$106.2m = 25% of S&M; is a MODEL ALLOCATION slightly below that variable share — residual after payroll carve.
CapEx base % of rev	0.02	FIND in ZI FY24: Unlevered FCF \$446.9m on \$1,214.3m rev (asset-light SaaS)	FACT in source: ZI generates large FCF vs revenue (asset-light). Our CapEx = 2% of rev is a MODEL PLANNING rate for maintenance CapEx — filing supports low capital intensity, not the exact 2% plug.
WC base % of Δrev	0.02	FIND: ZI receivables turnover ~80 days	FACT in source: ~80 receivable days ⇒ WC scales with growth. Our ΔNWC = 2% of Δrev is a MODEL PLANNING plug consistent with that WC intensity — not a line that says “2%.”

TLA rate (SOFR+4)	=C14+C15	FIND: TLA = SOFR + senior spread (formula)	COMPUTED: C14+C15. Evidence for components is on rows 14–15 (official SOFR + published TLA spread band). All-in ~8.3% with current inputs.
TLB rate (SOFR+5)	=C14+C16	FIND: TLB = SOFR + institutional spread (formula)	COMPUTED: C14+C16. Evidence for components is on rows 14 & 16 (official SOFR + published TLB SOFR+300–500bps band). All-in ~9.3% with current inputs.

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